

MERCY

Dedication

To My Children

Shahzur • Aleena • Shaheem • Aleesa • Shahraan

You have brought more joy into my life than you will ever know.
I often wonder if I have been the father you deserve.
When I think of my own father, I realize that I am only half
the father he has been to me. I try my best.
Some days I succeed. Some days I fall short.
But there is one thing I can say without the slightest hesitation:
I am proud of every one of you. Not because of your grades.
Not because of your achievements. Not because of what you may become.
I am proud of who you already are.

As you grow older, life will sometimes knock you down.
You will make mistakes. You will fail. You will wonder if you are enough.
Whenever that day comes, remember this:

Even if I am no longer beside you... I will always be proud of you.
Never stop getting back up. Never stop returning to Allah.
Never stop believing that every sunrise is another chance to begin again.

I love you. Always.

— *Papa*